Maya Balakrishnan

800 W Campbell Road, Richardson, TX, 75080

maya.balakrishnan@utdallas.edu | (425)-516-2162 | Website: mayab.phd
US Citizen

Academic Appointments

University of Texas at Dallas (2024 -)

- Assistant Professor of Operations Management at the Naveen Jindal School of Management

Education

Harvard Business School (2019 - 2024)

- Ph.D. in Technology and Operations Management (graduation: 2024).
- Dissertation Committee: Kris Ferreira (Harvard Business School), Ryan Buell (Harvard Business School), Jordan Tong (Wisconsin School of Business)
- Dissertation Title: Designing Operations to Inspire Trust

Stanford University (2012 - 2016)

- B.S. in Computer Science with a specialization in Human-Computer Interaction (2016).
- Minor in Philosophy with a focus on practical rationality and decision-making (2016).

Research Interests

- Behavioral Operations Management
- Human-Algorithm Interaction
- Corporate Social Responsibility
- Decision Making under Uncertainty
- Lab Experiments

Publications

1. DiSorbo, M., Ferreira, K. J., **Balakrishnan, M.**, Tong, J. (2025). Warnings and Endorsements: Improving Human-AI Collaboration in the Presence of Outliers. *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management*. [link]
    - First place winner for the 2024 Production and Operations Management - College of Behavioral Operations Management Junior Scholar Paper Competition (Student awardee - Matt DiSorbo)
2. **Balakrishnan, M.**, Ferreira, K. J., & Tong, J. (2025). Human-Algorithm Collaboration with Private Information: Naive Advice Weighting Behavior and Mitigation. *Management Science*. [link]
    - First place winner for the 2023 Production and Operations Management - College of Behavioral Operations Management Junior Scholar Paper Competition.
    - Second place winner for the 2023 INFORMS Behavioral Operations Management Best Working Paper Competition.
    - Winner of the 2022 Advances in Decision Analyses Conference Best PhD Blitz Presentation.

[1] Updated September 14, 2026

3. **Balakrishnan, M.**, Nam, J., & Buell, R. W. (2025). Differentiating on Diversity: How Disclosing Workforce Diversity Influences Consumer Choice. *Production and Operations Management.* [link]
    - Finalist for the 2023 INFORMS Service Science Best Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Justice (DEIJ) paper competition.
4. Nam, J., **Balakrishnan, M.**, De Freitas, J., & Brooks, A.W. (2023). Speedy activists: Firm response time to sociopolitical events influences consumer behavior. *Journal of Consumer Psychology.* [link]
    - One of the top 10 most-cited papers published by *Journal of Consumer Psychology* in 2023

Other Publications

1. **Balakrishnan, M.** (2025). The Indispensable Human in the Age of AI. *ORMS Tomorrow.* [link]
2. Wood Brooks, A., Nam, J., **Balakrishnan, M.**, De Freitas, J. (2024). Speed Matters When Companies Respond to Social Issues. *Harvard Business Review.* [link]
3. Buell, R. W., Nam, J., **Balakrishnan, M.** (2024). Why Companies Should Share Their DEI Data (Even When It's Unflattering). *Harvard Business School Working Knowledge.* [link]

Working Papers

- **Balakrishnan, M.** & J. Nam Guardrails and Goals: How Task-Stance Fit Shapes Workers' Choice and Use of Generative AI. *Under review at Production & Operations Management.* [link]

Selected Research in Progress

- **Balakrishnan, M.**, Tong, J. Teaching "I Know It When I See It" to AI: Human–AI Collaboration for Transferring Tacit Decision Rules. *Experiments complete, writing paper.*
- **Balakrishnan, M.**, Nam, J., Huang, D., & Ahmadi, N. Consumer Choices and Learning under Differential Privacy. *Experiments conducted, analyzing data.*
- **Balakrishnan, M.**, Nam, J. The Human in the Data Pipeline: Behavioral Biases in Training Data Set Curation for AI. *Experiments complete, writing paper.*

Awards

- *Management Science* Distinguished Service Award - Reviewer (2025)
- *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management (M&SOM)* Meritorious Service Award - Reviewer (2025)
- First place winner for the 2024 Production and Operations Management - College of Behavioral Operations Management Junior Scholar Paper Competition - Awarded to coauthor Matt DiSorbo (June 2024)
- Second place winner for the 2023 INFORMS Behavioral Operations Management Best Working Paper Competition (October 2023)
- Finalist for the 2023 INFORMS Service Science Best Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Justice (DEIJ) Paper Competition (August 2023)
- First place winner for the 2023 Production and Operations Management - College of Behavioral Operations Management Junior Scholar Paper Competition (June 2023)
- Advances in Decision Analysis Conference - Best PhD Blitz Presentation Winner (June 2022).
- First place winner for Goldman Sachs Hackathon (September 2016)
- First place winner for the Stanford Computer Science department's Best Senior Project (June 2016)
- Winner of the Stanford Computer Science Senior Project Best iPhone App/Best Use of Apple Services Prize sponsored by Apple (June 2016)

Teaching Experience

University of Texas at Dallas

- Taught Managerial Methods in Decision Making under Uncertainty (Intro to Probability and Statistics)
- Developed and taught two new courses on Applications of AI in Supply Chain Management for undergraduate and masters students.
- Covered a history of AI algorithms through the lens of various supply chain applications from time series models used for demand forecasting to transformer-based neural nets used for analyzing supplier reports.
- Demonstrated how to use and implement each of these AI algorithms through whiteboard pseudo-code and live python coding sessions.
- Coded an original simulation that taught students how to develop and work alongside AI for demand forecasting in a dynamic environment.
- Sourced original materials for weekly readings from industry publications, contemporary research papers, podcasts, and news articles.
- Undergraduate course evaluations
  - "Overall, the course was excellent." 5.0/5.0
  - "Overall, this instructor was excellent." 5.0/5.0
- Graduate course evaluations
  - "Overall, the course was excellent." 4.90/5.0
  - "Overall, this instructor was excellent." 5.0/5.0
- Course evaluation comments
  - "This was the best class I have taken at this university by far! The professor was very knowledgeable, and everything we learned applied to real-world scenarios as the AI landscape keeps growing. The semester project was also a really great way for me to explore AI in companies and to help me find career opportunities."
  - "Would love a second course to learn more! I really enjoyed this course, the professor was very passionate about the material and put a lot of effort into teaching it to us."
  - "Loved how supply chain topics were covered using AI in text knowledge. The coding session given not only helped me personally to develop a model but also made me explore more such stuff. The session where industry experts came in from HP for a session helped all students to understand the current narrative of AI in supply chain and gave us a sense of directions rather than jargons. Professor of this subject was extremely well experienced and went through each assignment with points to improve."
  - "This was a unique learning experience. The course was AI and she taught something new, relevant and quantifiable. New applications and tools i never knew existed. She made a lot of sense and all the knowledge gained will propel in my future journey after grad school. This is my 1st value for tuition paid after 3 semesters as an international student at UTD. I sort of wish it was a 2 semester course and she had more time to do practical hands on usage of the tools. The reading reflections where we were given research papers was the best part as it provided so much of information of the current on going work and helped us relate more to the coursework. A few topic slides will help us carry this forward and prepare ourselves for interview as well."

Harvard Business School

- MBA Teaching Fellow for the Required Curriculum Technology and Operations Management course (Fall 2021, Fall 2022).
  - Created course problem sets and the mid-term exam

  - Held weekly review sessions and office hours
  - Organized and assisted with a production process simulation
  - Graded case study final exam essays
- Co-teacher for HBS's Intro to Python for Researchers workshop
(Fall 2021, Summer 2022, Fall 2022).
  - Proposed, developed, and co-taught a 3-day workshop for first and second year doctoral students and summer undergraduate Research Assistants
  - Covered package management and virtual environments, using an IDE for debugging, git and version control, cleaning and wrangling data in Python, plotting data, web scraping, using APIs, basic SQL, statistical modeling, and machine learning packages

Stanford University

- Teaching Assistant for Introduction to Computer Science
  - Held weekly recitations and office hours
  - Graded assignments and exams; held in-person student project reviews

Service

- Track Chair for POMS 2026 Teaching/Pedagogy in POM, September 2026 - May 2027
- Member of the JSOM Healthcare hiring committee, October 2025 - January 2026
- Member of the JSOM Mentorship committee, 2025
- Speaker at JSOM AI Day - Smart Start: AI for Students, April 2025
- Co-organizer of the *HBS Digital Doctoral Workshop* Seminar Series
  - Solicited calls for weekly presenters, selected presentations, organized the weekly workshop sessions, helped build a website advertising the workshop series
  - 2020 Fall; 2021 Spring; 2021 Fall; 2022 Spring
- Session organizer/chair at *Production & Operations Management 2023* under the Behavioral Operations Management track
- Ad hoc reviewer for: *Management Science*, *Manufacturing & Service Operations Management*, *Production & Operations Management*, *Service Science*

Invited Talks

2026

- University of Texas at Dallas - JSOM Operations Department
- University of Pennsylvania - Wharton Empirical OM PhD Seminar

2025

- University of Toronto - Rotman Operations Department, Young Scholar Seminar Series

2024

- University of Michigan Ross - Technology and Operations Department
- Emory University Goizueta - Information Systems and Operations Management department
- Microsoft Research - Fairness, Accountability, Transparency & Ethics in AI (FATE) Group

2023

- The Ohio State University Fisher - Operations and Business Analytics department
- Vanderbilt University Owen - Operations Management and Quantitative Methods department
- University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign - Information Systems, Operations Management, Supply Chain Management, & Business Analytics (IOSA) department
- University of Notre Dame Mendoza - IT, Analytics, and Operations (ITAO) department
- University of Washington Foster - Information Systems and Operations Management (ISOM) department
- INSEAD Fontainebleu - Technology and Operations Management department
- Boston College Carroll - Business Analytics department
- University of Wisconsin Madison - Operations and Supply Chain Management department
- University of Texas at Dallas Jindal - Operations Management department
- Boston University Questrom - Operations and Technology Management department
- Carnegie Mellon University Tepper - Operations Management department

Conference Presentations

* Presenter

- **Balakrishnan, M.***, & Nam, J. *The Human in the Data Pipeline: Behavioral Biases in Training Data Set Curation for AI.* INFORMS Manufacturing & Service Operations Management Conference. July 2026. (Boston, MA)
- **Balakrishnan, M.*** *Raising the Ceiling on What Students Can Learn with AI.* INFORMS Manufacturing & Service Operations Management Conference - Teaching Innovations Session. July 2026. (Boston, MA)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, & Tong, J. *Teaching "I Know It When I See It" to AI: Human–AI Collaboration for Transferring Tacit Decision Rules.* Production & Operations Management Conference. May 2026. (Reno, NV)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, & Nam, J. *The Human in the Data Pipeline: Behavioral Biases in Training Data Set Curation for AI.* Behavioral Operations Conference. May 2026. (Tempe, AZ)
- DosSantos DiSorbo, M., Johnson Ferreira, K., **Balakrishnan, M.***, & Tong, J. *Warnings and Endorsements: Improving Human-AI Collaboration in the Presence of Outliers.* Workshop in Management Science. January 2026. (Santa Cruz, Chile)
- McLaughlin, B. & **Balakrishnan, M.** *Learning about Learning: Encouraging Algorithm Alignment through Progressive Deployment.* INFORMS Annual Conference. October 2024. (Seattle, Washington)
- Nam, J., **Balakrishnan, M.***, De Freitas, J., & Brooks, A.W. *Speedy activists: Firm response time to sociopolitical events influences consumer behavior.* Workshop in Management Science. December 2023. (San Pedro, Chile)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Tong, J., & Ferreira, K. *Improving Human-Algorithm Collaboration: Causes and Mitigation of Over- and Under-Adherence.* Society for Judgment and Decision Making Annual Meeting. November 2023. (San Francisco, California)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Tong, J., & Ferreira, K. *Improving Human-Algorithm Collaboration: Causes and Mitigation of Over- and Under-Adherence.* INFORMS Annual Conference, Humans and Machines with Applications in Operations Session. October 2023. (Phoenix, Arizona)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Tong, J., & Ferreira, K. *Improving Human-Algorithm Collaboration: Causes and Mitigation of Over- and Under-Adherence.* INFORMS Annual Conference, Behavioral Operations Management Best Working Paper Competition Finalist Session. October 2023. (Phoenix, Arizona)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Nam, J., & Buell, R. W. *Differentiating on Diversity: How Disclosing Workforce Diversity Influences Consumer Choice.* INFORMS Annual Conference, Service Science DEIJ Award

Session. October 2023. (Phoenix, Arizona)

- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Nam, J., & Buell, R. W. *Differentiating on Diversity: How Disclosing Workforce Diversity Influences Consumer Choice.* Conference in Operational Excellence in Retailing - Wharton. June 2023. (Philadelphia, Pennsylvania)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Tong, J., & Ferreira, K. *Improving Human-Algorithm Collaboration: Causes and Mitigation of Over- and Under-Adherence.* Manufacturing & Service Operations Management Conference 2023. June 2023. (Montreal, Canada)
- Nam, J., **Balakrishnan, M.***, De Freitas, J., & Brooks, A.W. *Speedy activists: Firm response time to sociopolitical events influences consumer behavior.* Behavioral Operations Conference. June 2023. (Baltimore, Maryland)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Tong, J., & Ferreira, K. *Improving Human-Algorithm Collaboration: Causes and Mitigation of Over- and Under-Adherence.* Production and Operations Management Society. May 2023. (Orlando, Florida)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Nam, J., & Buell, R. W. *Differentiating on Diversity: How Disclosing Workforce Diversity Improves Brand Attitudes.* Production and Operations Management Society. May 2023. (Orlando, Florida)
- **Balakrishnan, M.**, Nam, J.*, & Buell, R. W. *Differentiating on Diversity: How Disclosing Workforce Diversity Improves Brand Attitudes.* Marketing Science Conference on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion. March 2023. (SMU Cox)
- Nam, J., **Balakrishnan, M.***, De Freitas, J., & Brooks, A.W. *Speedy activists: Firm response time to sociopolitical events influences consumer behavior.* Society for Consumer Psychology. March 2023. (San Juan, Puerto Rico)
- **Balakrishnan, M.**, Nam, J.*, & Buell, R. W. *Differentiating on Diversity: How Disclosing Workforce Diversity Improves Brand Attitudes.* Society for Consumer Psychology. March 2023. (San Juan, Puerto Rico)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Tong, J., & Ferreira, K. *Improving Human-Algorithm Collaboration: Causes and Mitigation of Over- and Under-Adherence.* Workshop in Management Science. January 2023. (Puerto Varas, Chile)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Tong, J., & Ferreira, K. *Unlocking algorithm potential: overcoming naive advice weighting with feature transparency.* INFORMS Annual Conference, Behavioral OM Track, Human-Machine Interactions Session. October 2022. (Indianapolis)
- **Balakrishnan, M.**, Nam, J.*, & Buell, R. W. *Differentiating on Diversity: How Disclosing Workforce Diversity Improves Brand Attitudes.* INFORMS Annual Conference, Behavioral OM Track, Incorporating Consumer Preferences in Behavioral OM Session. October 2022. (Indianapolis)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Tong, J., & Ferreira, K. *Unlocking algorithm potential: overcoming naive advice weighting with feature transparency.* Advances in Decision Analysis. June 2022. (University of Virginia, Darden)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Nam, J., & Buell, R. W. *Differentiating on Diversity: How Disclosing Workforce Diversity Improves Brand Attitudes.* Behavioral Operations Conference. June 2022. (University of Arkansas)
- **Balakrishnan, M.**, Tong, J.*, & Ferreira, K. *Unlocking algorithm potential: overcoming naive advice weighting with feature transparency.* Behavioral Operations Conference. June 2022. (University of Arkansas)
- **Balakrishnan, M.***, Tong, J., & Ferreira, K. *Unlocking algorithm potential: overcoming naive advice weighting with feature transparency.* Production and Operations Management Annual Conference. April 2022. (Online)
- **Balakrishnan, M.**, Epstein, N.*, & Choi, M. *An Empirical Study of Time Allotment and Delays in E-Commerce Delivery.* INFORMS Annual Conference, Behavioral OM Track, Human-Machine Interactions Session. October 2021. (Anaheim)
- Nam, J.*, **Balakrishnan, M.***, De Freitas, J., & Brooks, A.W. *Speedy activists: Firm response time*

to sociopolitical events influences consumer behavior. AMA Marketing and Public Policy. June 2021. (Online)

Professional Work Experience

Polymerize, Cofounder — 2017 - 2019

- Designed and developed a system to monitor and optimize manufacturing processes for the craft food industry
- Created algorithms to provide real-time suggestions on optimizing inventory turn, minimizing cost of goods sold, and maximizing production through optimal batch scheduling and lot tracking
- Secured $2 million in seed funding from VCs and angels and managed relationships with investors through monthly board meetings
- Managed workstreams of a 6 engineer team as CTO, which involved prototyping new features with customers, creating user stories, wireframes, technical specs, conducting code reviews, performance testing and optimization, and synthesis of user feedback
- Developed and monitored KPIs for product usage, customer acquisition and retention; set monthly OKR's for the company
- Created and optimized a sales pipeline that led to customers moving from initial contact to daily product usage in 1 week

Goldman Sachs (Market Risk), Technology Analyst — 2016 - 2017

- Redesigned and developed internal market risk reports allowing for more interactivity and granularity of data views
- Prototyped a market risk report generated through Tableau and presented to Managing Directors to gain firm-wide project approval and secure more resources for execution
- Designed an optimized risk metrics authentication algorithm using a faster recursive solution in place of the old iterative process
- Supervised and outlined intern projects for 3 people, helping them through weekly 1:1's and conducting performance reviews

Goldman Sachs (Market Risk), Intern — 2015

- Optimized database processes to archive daily risk metrics for the firm, achieving a critical speedup from 14hrs to 6hrs
- Led a team of interns from multiple worldwide offices to ensure component compatibility and a successful launch of the product

Microsoft (Bing Ads), Intern — 2014

- Implemented an ad-management iOS and Android app that allows Bing Ads customers to view and edit campaigns on mobile devices
- Designed and created a cross-service REST API to pull ad information, updates, and optimization opportunities for ad campaigns

Skills and Activities

- **Programming**: Python, R, SQL, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, React, Django, oTree
- **Activities**: Art (painting, sewing, embroidery), cooking and baking, biking

References

Kris Johnson Ferreira

Edgerley Family Associate Professor of Business Administration
Harvard Business School - Technology and Operations Management
Morgan Hall 413. Soldiers Field Road, Boston, MA 02163.
Email: kferreira@hbs.edu

Ryan W. Buell

C. D. Spangler Professor of Business Administration
Harvard Business School - Technology and Operations Management
Morgan Hall 429. Soldiers Field Road, Boston, MA 02163.
Email: rbuell@hbs.edu

Jordan Tong

Wisconsin Naming Partners Professor and Associate Professor
Wisconsin School of Business - Operations and Information Management
975 University Avenue, Room 4293 Madison, WI 53706.
Email: jordan.tong@wisc.edu